

Space repetition around genuine mistakes

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Revisiting difficult material after a delay helps test whether you retained the idea. Repetition is most useful when you explain the mechanism, not when you remember a move by its diagram. Increase the interval after reliable full solutions.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Review a missed fork later that day, again after a few days, and later after a longer gap. On each review, name the targets, check the defender's resources, and calculate the line before revealing the answer.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How can you tell memory from understanding?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Change your explanation: state what would prevent the tactic, identify the critical defender, or compare a tempting alternative. Understanding should survive questions beyond the memorized first move.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Repeat the reasoning, not just the move.